

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, Audience Activation Platform.*

Positioning, CDP's AAP needs a PM who can hold technical architecture in one hand and donor-behavior insight in the other, I have done exactly that for 13 years.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY CDP

CDP has quietly become the operational backbone of American public media, more than 230 stations trusting a single platform for fundraising data and donor analytics is a serious infrastructure achievement, not a vanity metric. The Audience Activation Platform is the right next move: stitching real-world event data, volunteer activity, and donation signals into a unified donor view is a genuinely hard product problem, and the mission-driven constraint makes the design decisions more interesting, not less. I have shipped data platforms for government analytics and enterprise insurance from ambiguous requirements to production; the CDP context adds the donor-lifecycle dimension I find compelling. *That combination of civic mission and technically demanding platform work is exactly where I want to spend the next chapter.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming and acceptance-criteria drafts
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for client feedback
- **Cursor / VSCode**, daily development environment
- **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and interactive prototypes
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentation and documentation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation
- **GPT**, ideation, edge-case generation, and user-story drafts

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, Kafka, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

A two-sided B2B staffing marketplace built solo, zero to one, with LLM agents running the funnel.

- Matches construction firms with workers; anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing app-install friction entirely.
 - LLM agents handle inbound qualification, matching, and follow-up so one person runs the day-to-day operation.
 - Directly relevant to AAP: demonstrates ability to ship a data-connected, multi-stakeholder platform from zero without a dedicated team.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CDP

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I shadow the AAP engineering and data teams through one full sprint cycle, map every existing data source, events, donations, volunteer signals, against the current platform architecture, and identify the three largest gaps between what the backlog says and what users actually need.

WEEK 2

Slice and validate.

I take the highest-priority epic, break it into user stories with acceptance criteria and a definition of done, run it past a station client for a quick AI-assisted prototype review, and confirm the sprint team has enough clarity to start estimation.

Ship, close loops.

I own the daily standup cadence, triage any bugs surfacing from the previous sprint, and deliver the first velocity and KPI report to product and technology leadership, establishing the reporting rhythm the team will carry forward.

I COVER LETTER

Dear CDP Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Product Manager role on the Audience Activation Platform. CDP's model, pooling fundraising operations and data infrastructure across more than 230 public media organizations, is one of the more thoughtful applications of platform economics I have seen applied to a mission-driven sector. The AAP sits at the most interesting part of that model: building a unified donor view from fragmented signals is exactly the kind of technically demanding, strategically consequential product problem I have spent my career on.

My most directly relevant experience is the internal AI and data platform I managed at Rohde & Schwarz for the FCAS European defence programme. I led a cross-functional team of 15-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum, translated ambiguous programme-level requirements into sprint-ready user stories with clear acceptance criteria and a definition of done, and drove a GitOps rollout with ArgoCD that compressed deployment time from days to 30 minutes. Before that, at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I owned a national labour-market analytics platform end to end: I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual ETL, cutting per-update time by roughly 75%, while simultaneously carrying a UI relaunch and a full bare-metal-to-container migration. Both roles required holding the data architecture conversation with engineers in the morning and the stakeholder alignment conversation with leadership in the afternoon, which is precisely the bridging work the AAP PM role describes.

On the AI-assisted prototyping requirement: I use Claude Code, Lovable, Framer, and GitHub Copilot daily, not as experiments but as the actual workflow for turning requirements into something a client can react to in the same week. At CLINET Platforms I took a five-person team facing an undeliverable roadmap, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Speed of the feedback loop, from requirement to prototype to client reaction, is what made that possible. I would bring the same approach to AAP station clients from day one.

One honest note: my direct experience is in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare rather than public media fundraising specifically. The donor-lifecycle mechanics and PMO relationship model are new context I would need to absorb quickly. What transfers completely is the underlying product work: translating complex, multi-stakeholder data

requirements into a prioritized backlog, assessing API integration feasibility, tracking velocity against KPIs, and communicating trade-offs in plain language to non-technical audiences. I have done all of that in regulated, high-accountability environments where getting it wrong had real consequences.

I am fully remote-capable, available at short notice, and genuinely motivated by what CDP is building. I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to the AAP roadmap.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and fintech. I translate ambiguous requirements into prioritized backlogs, lead cross-functional teams through Agile delivery, and hold the technical architecture conversation with engineers and the outcome conversation with leadership simultaneously. Seeking a platform PM role where data quality and donor insight are the product.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, SDLC.

SDLC and Delivery Practices: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, branching strategy, regression and end-to-end test automation, containerised environments, defect-to-fix and cycle time as product metrics.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA 2024-2025

Led cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists; drove GitOps rollout cutting deployment time from days to 30 minutes; increased pipeline runs 200% by redirecting strategy based on user workflow analysis. Scrum in Jira and Confluence; ArgoCD, Kubernetes, Python, Dagster.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned national labour-market analytics Platform end to end; introduced Dagster and dbt saving ~75% time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers; carried full UI relaunch and large ETL migration concurrently. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023-2023

Cut undeliverable roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Integrated CGM interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS INSURANCE 2022-2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, anonymity-until-payment model. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software; shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Took fertiliser product from lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH PAYMENTS
2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments; built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · CDP

